

KMVTECH Education

Environmental & Conservation Psychology

Module 4 — Environmental Communication & Media · Lesson 4.1

Environmental Communication

Learning Objectives

- Define environmental communication and explain why it matters
- Identify the five key functions of environmental communication
- Name the five elements of the communication process
- Apply the six principles of effective message design
- Identify and explain five barriers to effective communication in Uganda

Key Terms

- | | |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------|
| • Environmental communication | • Information sharing |
| • Behaviour change communication | • Democratic participation |
| • Message framing | • Communication channel |
| • Sender | • Receiver |
| • Feedback | • Language barriers |
| • Trust deficit | |

1. What Is Environmental Communication?

Environmental communication is the exchange of information, ideas, and meanings about the natural environment. It is the bridge between environmental knowledge and environmental action.

Without effective communication, scientific findings stay locked in journals, campaigns fail to change behaviour, and environmental crises escalate without public pressure to respond.

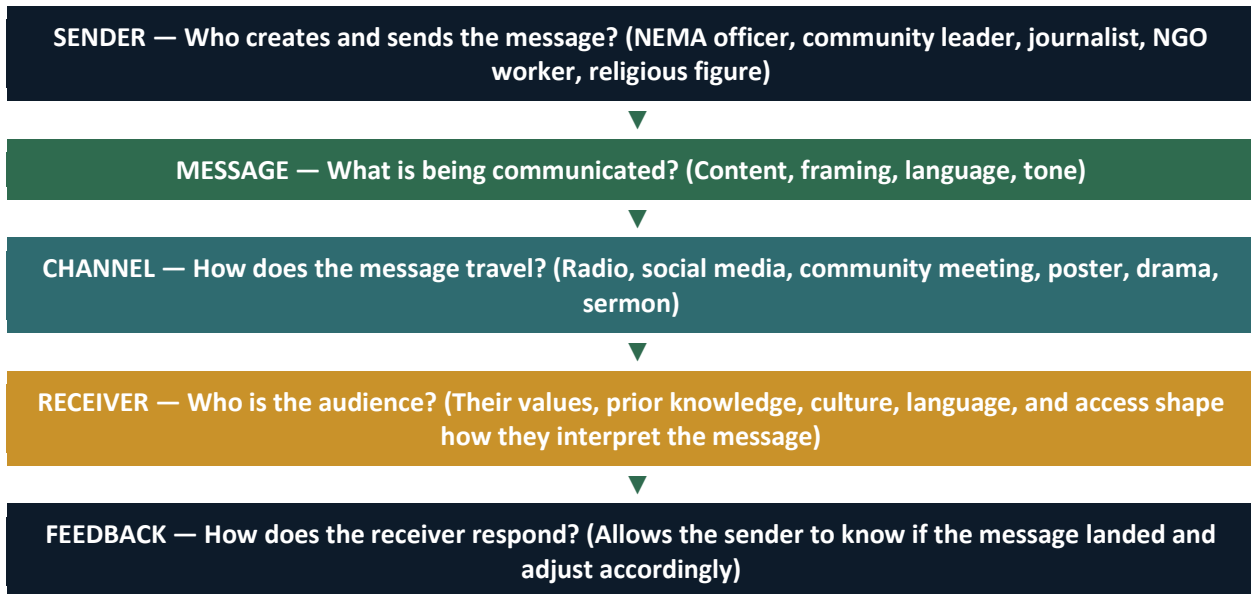
2. Five Functions of Environmental Communication

Function	What It Does	Uganda Example
Information sharing	Transmitting accurate environmental knowledge to communities, policymakers, and businesses	NEMA reports on wetland coverage; Radio reports on flooding causes
Persuasion & attitude change	Moving people from knowing about a problem to caring about it	Community drama programmes showing effects of plastic waste on flooding
Behaviour change support	Providing practical knowledge and social support to adopt sustainable behaviour	Cookstove adoption programmes combining demonstration with community promotion
Democratic participation	Enabling communities to participate in environmental decisions that affect them	Local council meetings on wetland protection; Environmental Impact Assessment consultations

Conflict resolution	Mediating between competing interests around environmental resources	Dialogue between fishing communities and developers over Lake Victoria wetlands
---------------------	--	---

3. The Communication Process

Every act of environmental communication involves five elements. When any element is poorly designed, communication fails.



4. Six Principles of Effective Environmental Messages

Principle	What It Means
1. Know your audience	Understand what they value, what they already know, what barriers they face, and what channels they use
2. Frame around audience values	'Trees protect your crops from drought' works better for farmers than 'trees save the planet'
3. Use the right channel	Rural Uganda: community radio in local language. Urban youth: social media. All communities: respected leaders
4. Make it concrete, local, personal	'Trees on the Bududa hills absorb rainfall' beats '10% of global greenhouse gas emissions come from deforestation'
5. Include a clear, achievable action	Tell the audience exactly what you want them to do — and make sure they can actually do it
6. Repeat across multiple channels	One exposure rarely changes behaviour. Multi-channel, long-term campaigns build social norms

5. Barriers to Effective Communication in Uganda

LANGUAGE Barriers	LITERACY Barriers	TRUST Deficits
• 40+ indigenous languages	• Written materials inaccessible in lower-literacy areas	• Low trust in government after broken promises

- English-only messages exclude most rural communities
- Solution: local language radio, visual materials

- Solution: radio, drama, oral communication through trusted figures

- Community leaders often more trusted than NEMA officers
- Solution: work through respected local figures

Other Barrier	Explanation
Misinformation	False claims about climate change causes spread through social media and rumour networks, competing with accurate messages
Information overload	Urban Ugandans receive enormous daily volumes of information; environmental messages compete with entertainment and political news

🔗 Uganda Connection

NEMA's kaveera ban initially struggled because communication focused on legal threats rather than persuasion, and failed to ensure affordable alternatives were available. Community radio programmes in local languages, with drama and call-in formats, have consistently outperformed English-language poster campaigns at building community environmental knowledge in rural Uganda.

✔ Lesson Summary

1. Environmental communication bridges environmental knowledge and environmental action
2. Five functions: information sharing, persuasion, behaviour change, democratic participation, conflict resolution
3. The communication process has five elements: sender, message, channel, receiver, feedback
4. Effective messages are audience-specific, value-framed, locally concrete, and include a clear achievable action
5. Key barriers in Uganda: language diversity, low literacy, trust deficits, misinformation, and information overload

📝 Quick Revision

1. Define environmental communication in one sentence.
2. Name the five functions of environmental communication.
3. Name and explain the five elements of the communication process.
4. Why is 'trees protect your crops from drought' a better message for Ugandan farmers than 'trees reduce global emissions'?
5. Why are community leaders often more effective environmental communicators than government officials in Uganda?

KMVTECH Education

Environmental & Conservation Psychology

Module 4 — Environmental Communication & Media · Lesson 4.2

Journalism & Environmental Reporting

📌 Learning Objectives

- Explain the four roles of environmental journalism
- Identify challenges facing environmental journalists in Uganda
- Define environmental misinformation and explain its psychological mechanisms
- Apply counter-communication strategies to environmental misinformation

📌 Key Terms

- | | |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------|
| • Environmental journalism | • Agenda-setting |
| • Accountability journalism | • Investigative reporting |
| • Environmental misinformation | • Confirmation bias |
| • Illusory truth effect | • Counter-communication |
| • Uganda Radio Network | • AFIEGO |

1. Four Roles of Environmental Journalism

Role	What It Does	Uganda Example
Informing the public	Translates complex science and policy into stories ordinary people can understand	Radio reports explaining why Kampala floods when wetlands are built over
Accountability	Investigates and exposes illegal dumping, pollution, corrupt officials, and policy failures	Daily Monitor and New Vision investigations into wetland encroachment by developers with political connections
Amplifying community voices	Gives communities affected by environmental problems a platform to speak to policymakers	Reporting on communities displaced by oil exploration in the Albertine Rift
Agenda-setting	Sustained coverage signals importance, putting pressure on politicians to act	Consistent reporting on deforestation contributed to government crackdowns on illegal logging

Key Insight

Environmental journalism does not just report on politics — it shapes what politicians feel pressured to act on. Sustained media coverage of an environmental issue consistently elevates it on the political agenda.

2. Challenges Facing Environmental Journalists in Uganda

RESOURCES & FUNDING

TRAINING & ACCESS

POLITICAL SENSITIVITY

- Field reporting is expensive
- Environmental stories need time to develop
- Editors prioritise daily political and commercial news

- Many reporters are general journalists, not environmental specialists
- Accessing restricted areas is difficult
- Reporting on illegal activity carries physical risk

- Stories involving powerful actors face editorial resistance
- Media owners may avoid stories threatening advertisers or political allies
- Some journalists have received threats for investigative environmental reporting

3. Environmental Misinformation

Environmental misinformation is false or misleading information about environmental issues — including climate change denial, false claims about the causes of floods and droughts, and conspiracy theories about conservation programs.

Why Misinformation Is So Effective — Four Psychological Mechanisms

Mechanism	What It Means	Environmental Example
Confirmation bias	People seek and believe information that confirms existing beliefs	A person who sees the economy as more important than environment will readily believe climate change is exaggerated
Illusory truth effect	Repeated false claims begin to feel true simply through familiarity	Repeatedly hearing 'climate change is natural variation' makes it feel credible even without evidence
Source credibility	Misinformation from trusted sources (community leaders, WhatsApp contacts) is more believed	A false claim shared by a respected elder about conservation programs causing food insecurity spreads quickly
Emotional engagement	Claims that trigger fear or anger spread and are remembered more than neutral correct information	'Conservation programs will take your land' is more emotionally compelling than the accurate legal explanation

4. Counter-Communication — How to Fight Misinformation

Simply repeating correct information does NOT overcome misinformation. Research shows the most effective counter-communication strategy:

ACKNOWLEDGE the false claim directly — do not ignore it



EXPLAIN why people believe it (the psychological mechanism) — this reduces its credibility



REPLACE with an alternative explanation that is equally simple and emotionally resonant



USE TRUSTED COMMUNITY SOURCES — not distant scientists or government officials



REPEAT the correct message consistently across multiple trusted channels

?? Uganda Connection

Uganda Radio Network (URN) operates community radio stations broadcasting environmental content in local languages across Uganda. Their drama programmes, call-in shows, and local-language reporting on climate change have been measurably more effective at building community environmental knowledge than English-language poster campaigns — because they use the right channel, the right language, and trusted local voices.

✔ Lesson Summary

1. Environmental journalism performs four roles: informing, accountability, amplifying voices, and agenda-setting
2. Ugandan journalists face challenges of limited funding, specialist training gaps, access difficulties, and political sensitivity
3. Environmental misinformation is effective because of confirmation bias, the illusory truth effect, source credibility, and emotional engagement
4. Counter-communication must acknowledge, explain, replace, use trusted sources, and repeat — not just assert the truth louder

? Quick Revision

1. Name the four roles of environmental journalism.
2. What is the illusory truth effect and why is it relevant to misinformation?
3. Why does simply repeating correct information fail to counter environmental misinformation?
4. Name two challenges facing environmental journalists in Uganda.
5. What role has the Uganda Radio Network played in environmental communication?

KMVTECH Education

Environmental & Conservation Psychology

Module 5 — Climate Change Psychology · Lesson 5.1

Psychological Effects of Climate Change

Learning Objectives

- Define eco-anxiety and explain why it is considered a rational response
- Define climate grief (ecological grief) and connect it to solastalgia
- Explain the difference between acute stress and PTSD following environmental disasters
- Apply these concepts to Ugandan examples

Key Terms

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------|
| • Eco-anxiety | • Environmental distress |
| • Climate grief | • Ecological grief |
| • Solastalgia | • Glenn Albrecht |
| • Acute stress response | • PTSD |
| • Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder | • Psychological First Aid |
| • Bududa landslide | • Karamoja drought |

1. Eco-Anxiety

Eco-anxiety is the chronic fear, worry, and distress that arises from awareness of environmental threats — particularly climate change, biodiversity loss, and pollution. It is not a formal diagnosis but a psychological response to real, documented threats.

What eco-anxiety can look like	
Persistent worry about the planet's future that intrudes on daily life	Feelings of helplessness and hopelessness about climate change
Anger at governments or corporations for failing to act	Grief for lost natural environments and species
Sleep disturbance and difficulty concentrating linked to environmental worry	In severe cases: avoiding environmental news entirely

Important Distinction

Eco-anxiety is NOT irrational. Environmental psychologists consider it a rational response to genuine threats. The problem is not feeling worried about climate change — the problem arises when worry becomes paralysing rather than motivating. The goal is not to convince people threats aren't real, but to help them respond in ways that sustain wellbeing and effective action.

What Helps With Eco-Anxiety

- Taking meaningful action — even small — restores sense of agency and counters helplessness
- Connecting with others who share environmental concerns and are also acting

- Spending time in nature (as ART and SRT from Module 1 predict)
- Developing a realistic but hopeful narrative — acknowledging severity without succumbing to total hopelessness

?? Uganda Connection

Young people in flood-prone eastern Uganda live with ongoing anxiety about the next rain season. Farmers in Karamoja experience sustained worry about food security linked to changing rainfall. Communities near disappearing wetlands experience eco-anxiety about the loss of ecosystems they depend on. These are not abstract global concerns — they are lived daily realities.

2. Climate Grief

Climate grief (ecological grief) is the sadness, mourning, and sense of loss felt when natural environments are destroyed, species go extinct, or landscapes disappear. It is grief in the full psychological sense — but its object is the natural world.

What people grieve	
Loss of species — extinction of animals and plants	Loss of places — forests, glaciers, wetlands that once existed
Loss of ecosystem services — the practical support that ecosystems provided	Loss of future possibilities — grief for the world that environmental destruction is preventing

Solastalgia

Coined by Glenn Albrecht — the psychological distress caused by watching a place you love change or disappear around you. Unlike nostalgia (missing a place you left), solastalgia is the pain of watching your home environment degrade while you are still in it. Communities in Bududa watching hillsides erode, or Kampala communities watching wetlands disappear, experience solastalgia.

Key Finding From Research

Grief and action can coexist. Some of the most committed environmental advocates are people who have grieved deeply for what has been lost and channelled that grief into protecting what remains. Conservation programs that acknowledge community grief — rather than rushing past it to solutions — build stronger relationships and more sustained engagement.

?? Uganda Connection

The recession of Rwenzori glaciers — projected to be glacier-free within decades — is mourned by scientists and mountain communities. Lake Victoria fishing communities whose catch has declined dramatically through overfishing, pollution, and water hyacinth grieve the loss of a way of life. Uganda's forest cover loss is mourned by conservation scientists and communities whose cultural and spiritual life was tied to those forests. These losses are real and the grief is psychologically legitimate.

3. Stress & Trauma From Environmental Disasters

Environmental disasters — floods, landslides, droughts — can produce lasting psychological harm that is as real and serious as physical injury, yet far less visible and less likely to receive support.

Phase	What Happens	How Long
-------	--------------	----------

Acute Stress Response	Fear, panic, disorientation, physical symptoms (rapid heartbeat, shortness of breath). NORMAL survival mechanisms — body mobilising for threat.	Days to 2 weeks
PTSD (in 15–40% of survivors)	Intrusive memories and flashbacks; Hyperarousal (constant high alertness); Avoidance of reminders; Negative mood, hopelessness, social withdrawal.	Months to years if untreated

📍 Uganda Connection

The 2010 Bududa landslide killed over 300 people and left many survivors with lasting trauma — documented PTSD, depression, and complicated grief years after the event. In Karamoja, severe droughts destroy cattle herds — and with them cultural identity and social standing. The psychological consequences (depression, hopelessness, family breakdown) are real but rarely receive formal mental health support. Kampala's annual floods create chronic anticipatory anxiety among residents of low-lying areas like Bwaise during every rainy season.

Psychological First Aid (PFA)

PFA is an evidence-based approach to supporting disaster survivors. Its five principles:

- Safety — ensure people are safe and feel safe
- Calming — help people regulate overwhelming emotions
- Connectedness — reconnect people with family, community, support
- Self-efficacy — restore people's belief that they can cope
- Hope — provide realistic information about the path forward

✔ Lesson Summary

1. Eco-anxiety is chronic distress from awareness of environmental threats — rational but problematic when paralyzing
2. Climate grief is mourning the loss of natural environments, species, and future possibilities
3. Solastalgia: distress from watching your home environment change around you (Glenn Albrecht)
4. Acute stress response is a normal, temporary reaction to disaster; PTSD is a prolonged clinical condition affecting 15–40% of survivors
5. Psychological First Aid addresses safety, calming, connectedness, self-efficacy, and hope

📖 Quick Revision

1. Define eco-anxiety. Why is it considered rational rather than irrational?
2. What is solastalgia and how does it differ from nostalgia?
3. Name three things in the natural world that communities in Uganda may grieve.
4. What distinguishes an acute stress response from PTSD?
5. Name the five principles of Psychological First Aid.

KMVTECH Education
Environmental & Conservation Psychology
 Module 5 — Climate Change Psychology · Lesson 5.2
Psychological Responses to Climate Change

📖 Learning Objectives

- Define the three types of climate change denial
- Explain the psychological mechanisms behind denial
- Distinguish between problem-focused, emotion-focused, and meaning-focused coping
- Define maladaptive coping and identify examples
- Explain community resilience and psychological adaptation

📖 Key Terms

- | | |
|--------------------------|----------------------------|
| • Literal denial | • Interpretive denial |
| • Implicatory denial | • Confirmation bias |
| • Cognitive dissonance | • System justification |
| • Problem-focused coping | • Emotion-focused coping |
| • Meaning-focused coping | • Maladaptive coping |
| • Community resilience | • Psychological adaptation |

1. Three Types of Climate Denial

LITERAL DENIAL	INTERPRETIVE DENIAL	IMPLICATORY DENIAL
• 'Climate change is not happening' • Rejects all scientific evidence • Least common in Uganda where visible changes make this hard to sustain	• 'It's getting hotter but that's natural variation — not human-caused' • Accepts the facts but disputes the cause • Moderate frequency in Uganda	• 'Yes climate change is real and human-caused — but I can't do anything about it' • Accepts facts and cause, denies personal responsibility • MOST COMMON and MOST CONSEQUENTIAL form in Uganda

2. Psychological Mechanisms Behind Denial

Mechanism	How It Works	Why It Matters
Confirmation bias	People seek information that confirms existing beliefs and discount challenging information	Climate information is psychologically threatening to those with economic interests in fossil fuels or traditional land use
Cognitive dissonance	Awareness of conflict between current behaviour and environmental facts creates discomfort — denial resolves the discomfort	If I accept climate change is real I must change my behaviour; denying it allows me to continue as before

System justification	People tend to justify existing social and economic systems	Accepting that the current system causes climate change requires accepting the system needs fundamental change
Social identity	If denial is associated with a group one belongs to, it becomes part of personal identity	Political or cultural tribal affiliation can make denial feel like loyalty

How to Respond to Denial

Simply providing more information rarely works — denial is not primarily an information problem. More effective: acknowledge the values and concerns behind the denial; connect climate information to what the person already cares about; use trusted community figures as messengers; focus on local, observable changes rather than global abstractions.

3. Three Types of Healthy Coping

PROBLEM-FOCUSED Coping	EMOTION-FOCUSED Coping	MEANING-FOCUSED Coping
• Directly addressing the threat through action • Growing drought-resistant crops • Installing water harvesting systems • Joining environmental campaigns • Restores sense of agency — reduces eco-anxiety	• Managing distress from environmental threats • Seeking social support • Spending time in nature • Mindfulness and spiritual practices • NOT the same as avoidance — maintaining capacity to engage	• Finding purpose in environmental work despite uncertainty • Connecting personal actions to larger goals • Celebrating small victories • Maintaining narrative that effort matters even without guaranteed outcomes

4. Maladaptive Coping — What NOT to Do

Maladaptive Response	What It Looks Like	Why It's Harmful
Avoidance & denial	Refusing to read or discuss environmental news	Prevents processing and action; worsens long-term wellbeing
Numbing	Using alcohol, entertainment, or overwork to avoid thinking about environmental problems	Short-term comfort at cost of long-term wellbeing and agency
Scapegoating	Blaming only corporations, governments, or foreign countries	Removes personal responsibility and justifies inaction
Despair	Concluding the situation is hopeless and stopping all engagement	Abandons the possibility of positive change

5. Community Resilience & Psychological Adaptation

Individual coping is only part of the picture. Communities as a whole show variable resilience to environmental threats.

Factor Building Community Resilience	Example from Uganda
Strong social networks and mutual aid systems	Communities with active clan and neighbourhood mutual aid systems recovered faster after Bududa landslide

Trusted, effective community leadership	Religious leaders and local council leaders who organised community response improved recovery outcomes
Diverse livelihood options	Communities with multiple income streams beyond single-crop farming were more resilient to drought in Karamoja
Cultural frameworks for making sense of adversity	Traditional mourning ceremonies, spiritual practices, and community storytelling supported psychological recovery

Psychological Adaptation

Technical adaptation (new crop varieties, flood barriers) often fails without psychological adaptation — communities adjusting their understanding, expectations, and relationship to a changed environment. You cannot ask communities to plan for a different environmental future without acknowledging the psychological work of accepting that the old future is no longer available.

🔗 Uganda Connection

In Karamoja, adaptation programs that only offer new livelihoods without acknowledging the psychological and cultural loss of traditional cattle herding consistently face community resistance. Programs that address the grief and identity dimensions alongside practical alternatives show better uptake and sustainability.

✔ Lesson Summary

1. Three denial types: literal (facts rejected), interpretive (cause disputed), implicatory (responsibility denied — most common)
2. Denial is driven by confirmation bias, cognitive dissonance, system justification, and social identity
3. Healthy coping: problem-focused (act), emotion-focused (manage distress), meaning-focused (find purpose)
4. Maladaptive coping: avoidance, numbing, scapegoating, despair — protect short-term comfort at long-term cost
5. Community resilience depends on social networks, trusted leadership, livelihood diversity, and cultural frameworks
6. Psychological adaptation is as important as technical adaptation — it cannot be skipped

📝 Quick Revision

1. Name and briefly define the three types of climate change denial.
2. What is cognitive dissonance and how does it contribute to denial?
3. What is the difference between problem-focused and emotion-focused coping?
4. Give two examples of maladaptive coping with environmental stress.
5. Why does community resilience matter alongside individual coping?

KMVTECH Education

Environmental & Conservation Psychology

Module 6 — Community, Disasters & Conservation Behaviour · Lesson 6.1

Community, Disasters & Conservation Behaviour

📖 Learning Objectives

- Explain how environmental disasters affect communities at multiple levels
- Describe the solidarity-to-breakdown trajectory in community disaster response
- Define environmental trauma and explain the three phases of recovery
- Explain why community participation in conservation produces better outcomes
- Apply these concepts to Uganda case studies

📖 Key Terms

- | | |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------|
| • Community disaster response | • Social disruption |
| • Differential vulnerability | • Compounding effects |
| • Environmental trauma | • Ongoing trauma |
| • Collective trauma | • Recovery phases |
| • Social capital | • Fortress conservation |
| • Community participation | • Participation ladder |

1. How Environmental Disasters Affect Communities

Environmental disasters are not only individual tragedies — they are community events that disrupt the social fabric that holds communities together.

Dimension of Impact	What Is Disrupted	Uganda Example
Social	Social networks, mutual aid systems, community relationships	Landslide survivors separated from their community network; trust between neighbours strained over aid distribution
Economic	Shared land, water infrastructure, community markets	Karamoja drought destroys communally managed water points and grazing lands
Cultural	Cultural heritage sites, traditional practices, shared environmental knowledge	Flooding of ancestral burial grounds; loss of traditional fishing knowledge as fish stocks disappear
Leadership	Community leaders killed, displaced, or discredited	Deaths of respected elders in landslides remove critical decision-making capacity during recovery

2. From Solidarity to Breakdown

Phase	What Typically Happens
-------	------------------------

Immediate aftermath	Surge of community solidarity — neighbours help neighbours, conflict decreases, mutual aid increases. Communities 'come together'.
As recovery begins	Solidarity becomes fragile. Inequitable aid distribution causes resentment. Competition for limited resources fractures community bonds. Political actors may exploit the situation.
Key finding	Communities with strong pre-existing social cohesion maintain solidarity longer. Communities with pre-existing divisions fragment more quickly under pressure.

Differential Vulnerability

Disasters do not affect everyone equally. Women, children, older adults, and economically marginalised people are consistently more vulnerable — less mobility, fewer resources, less access to warning systems, excluded from reconstruction decisions. Gender-sensitive disaster response is essential.

🔗 Uganda Connection

Women in flood-affected Ugandan communities often bear primary caregiving during disasters AND are excluded from reconstruction decision-making. Programs that do not actively address this inequity consistently fail to achieve equitable outcomes.

3. Environmental Trauma & Recovery

Environmental trauma has three distinctive features compared to individual trauma:

- **ONGOING** — not a single past event. Flood-prone communities face the trauma risk every rainy season
- **GRADUAL** — slow environmental degradation (drying river, disappearing forest) accumulates as chronic trauma
- **COLLECTIVE** — whole communities are simultaneously traumatised, depleting the support systems that individuals would normally turn to

Three Phases of Recovery

PHASE 1 — Immediate Response (hours to weeks) Stabilise safety · Address physical needs · Prevent further harm



PHASE 2 — Short-term Recovery (weeks to months) Restore social connections · Provide Psychological First Aid · Begin processing grief and shock



PHASE 3 — Long-term Recovery (months to years) Rebuild livelihoods · Process deeper trauma · Restore cultural life · Develop new adaptive capacity

Five Factors Determining Recovery Outcomes

Factor	Why It Matters
Social support	Strong networks recover faster — mutual aid fills gaps that institutions cannot reach
Economic resources	Access to money, materials, and livelihood alternatives determines ability to rebuild
Trusted leadership	Effective leaders coordinate recovery and maintain community cohesion
Mental health support	Communities where psychological needs are acknowledged recover more completely

Sense of agency	Communities with control over their own recovery process show better outcomes than those entirely dependent on external help
-----------------	--

4. Why Community Participation Matters in Conservation

'Fortress conservation' — the historic top-down model of protecting environments by excluding communities — has consistently produced poor outcomes in Uganda and across Africa.

Fortress Conservation Produces...	Community-Led Conservation Produces...
Resentment toward conservation authorities	Ownership — 'this is ours to protect'
'The government's problem, not mine' — reduced stewardship	Moral responsibility activated (NAM) through genuine participation
Communities actively undermining conservation programs	Communities as active conservation partners and watchdogs
Erosion of traditional conservation knowledge	Integration of local ecological knowledge into conservation practice

The Participation Ladder



Three Uganda Cases That Illustrate These Principles

Case	What Happened	Lesson
Bududa resettlement	Government relocation from high-risk hillsides faced community resistance — families returned to dangerous areas	Place identity and community attachment are as powerful as physical safety concerns. Relocation must address psychological dimensions.
Mount Elgon buffer zone	Community-based natural resource management (allowing resource harvesting under agreed rules) produced better conservation outcomes than pure enforcement	Communities given genuine stake in conservation become active protectors, not threats
Lubigi wetland groups	Community women's groups and elders monitor and protect the wetland without external direction — motivated by direct connection to and dependence on the wetland	Place Identity + NAM in action: connection + personal responsibility = sustained voluntary conservation behaviour

✓ Lesson Summary

1. Disasters disrupt communities at social, economic, cultural, and leadership levels simultaneously
2. The immediate post-disaster solidarity is real but fragile — community cohesion before the disaster predicts recovery
3. Environmental trauma is distinct: ongoing, gradual, and collective — depleting the very support systems people need
4. Recovery has three phases (immediate, short-term, long-term) and five key factors (social support, resources, leadership, mental health, agency)
5. Fortress conservation fails; community participation at the collaboration and community-led levels produces better and more durable outcomes

Quick Revision

1. Name four dimensions at which environmental disasters affect communities.
2. What is 'differential vulnerability' and which groups are most vulnerable?
3. Name three distinctive features of environmental trauma compared to individual trauma.
4. Name the five factors that determine community recovery outcomes.
5. What is 'fortress conservation' and why does it fail?
6. Using the Lubigi wetland case, explain how Place Identity Theory and NAM combine to produce voluntary conservation behaviour.